
GOOD BUILDERS ARE GOOD STEWARDS

A 5-Day Journey of Faithfully Stewarding
What God Has Placed in Your Hands

ROOTED WITH KHETHIWE



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WELCOME, BUILDER



This is not a course about hustling your way into a bigger life. It is an invitation to faithfully steward the life God has already placed in your hands.

So many women are waiting for the big thing: the marriage, the home, the job, the money, the child, the ministry, the platform or the breakthrough. But God is also asking a quieter question: What is in your hands today?

Good builders are good stewards. They honour the material, time, people, resources and instructions already entrusted to them. They do not bury what God gave them. They build capacity through faithfulness.

BEFORE WE BEGIN: WHAT AM I HOPING GOD WILL ENTRUST TO ME?

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Each day includes the full Scripture readings, teaching, reflection and response.

BUILT ON FIVE PILLARS

ENTRUSTMENT

MEASURE

CAPACITY

FAITHFULNESS

MULTIPLICATION

GOOD BUILDERS ARE GOOD STEWARDS

Matthew 25:14–30

World English Bible

14 “For it is like a man going into another country, who called his own servants and entrusted his goods to them.

15 To one he gave five talents, to another two, to another one; to each according to his own ability. Then he went on his journey.

16 Immediately he who received the five talents went and traded with them, and made another five talents.

17 In the same way, he also who received the two gained another two.

18 But he who received the one talent went away and dug in the earth, and hid his lord’s money.

19 “Now after a long time the lord of those servants came, and settled accounts with them.

20 He who received the five talents came and brought another five talents, saying, ‘Lord, you delivered to me five talents. Behold, I have gained another five talents besides them.’

21 “His lord said to him, ‘Well done, good and faithful servant. You have been faithful over a few things, I will set you over many things. Enter into the joy of your lord.’

22 “He also who got the two talents came and said, ‘Lord, you delivered to me two talents. Behold, I have gained another two talents besides them.’

MATTHEW 25:14–30 CONTINUED

23 “His lord said to him, ‘Well done, good and faithful servant. You have been faithful over a few things, I will set you over many things. Enter into the joy of your lord.’

24 “He also who had received the one talent came and said, ‘Lord, I knew you, that you are a hard man, reaping where you didn’t sow, and gathering where you didn’t scatter.

25 I was afraid, and went away and hid your talent in the earth. Behold, you have what is yours.’

26 “But his lord answered him, ‘You wicked and slothful servant. You knew that I reap where I didn’t sow, and gather where I didn’t scatter.

27 Then you ought to have deposited my money with the bankers, and at my coming I should have received back my own with interest.

28 Take away therefore the talent from him, and give it to him who has the ten talents.

29 For to everyone who has will be given, and he will have abundance, but from him who doesn’t have, even that which he has will be taken away.

30 Throw out the unprofitable servant into the outer darkness, where there will be weeping and gnashing of teeth.’

The Parable of the Talents

Read Matthew 25:14–30 before beginning Day One. This parable is the anchor of this workbook.

Jesus tells of a master who goes away and entrusts his property to three servants. One receives five talents, another two and another one — each according to his own ability. The first two servants put what they receive to work and multiply it. The third buries his talent in the ground. When the master returns, each servant gives an account.

This Is a Parable About Entrustment

A talent was a significant unit of money, but the principle reaches beyond money. God entrusts people with time, capacity, provision, gifts, revelation, influence, relationships, homes, children, work and opportunities. Nothing in our hands is insignificant simply because it is ordinary or hidden.

Each Was Given a Measure

The master did not distribute equally, but he distributed intentionally. The servants were not asked to carry identical measures, and neither are we. Your capacity may look different from another woman's because your season, assignment, support and maturity are different. God does not require you to duplicate another person's load. He requires faithfulness with yours.

AS I READ MATTHEW 25, WHAT STANDS OUT TO ME?

WHAT THE PARABLE TEACHES US

1. What God entrusts must be stewarded.

The servants did not own the talents; they managed what belonged to the master. Stewardship begins when we stop treating our lives as casual possessions and start receiving them as holy trust.

2. Faithfulness builds capacity.

The servants who worked with their measure became able to carry more. Capacity is not only something we are given; it is built through disciplined faithfulness in the small things.

3. Fear is not faithful stewardship.

The third servant described fear, then used it to justify inaction. Fear may explain why we buried something, but it cannot become the final reason we leave it there.

4. We will give an account.

The master returned. This reminds us that stewardship has a future-facing seriousness. God sees not only what we were given, but what we did with it.

5. Neglect has consequences, but grace calls us back.

The buried talent was taken and given to the faithful servant. This is a stern warning: what we continually refuse to steward may be entrusted elsewhere. Yet if you have buried something, today is not for condemnation. Bring it into the light, repent where needed and begin again with what remains in your hands.

The Question Beneath the Parable

While you are waiting for the big thing, what is in your hands? This course is your answer. You do not have to force more. You are invited to faithfully build with what God has already given you.

WHAT I WILL NO LONGER BURY

What Is in Your Hands

“What is that in your hand?” — Exodus 4:2 (WEB)

Today's Truth

Your current life is not a waiting room for your assignment. It is the place where faithfulness is being formed.

Rooted Scripture Thread

Matthew 25:14–15 — The master begins by entrusting his own goods.

Exodus 4:2 — God begins Moses' deliverance assignment with a staff.

2 Kings 4:1–7 — The widow's small jar of oil becomes the starting point for provision.

John 6:5–13 — A boy's lunch is placed in Jesus' hands and becomes enough for thousands.

FULL SCRIPTURE READINGS

Read these passages slowly. Let the Word carry the weight of the teaching before you move into reflection.

Matthew 25:14-15

14 “For it is like a man, going into another country, who called his own servants, and entrusted his goods to them.

15 To one he gave five talents, to another two, to another one; to each according to his own ability. Then he went on his journey.

Exodus 4:2

2 Yahweh said to him, “What is that in your hand?” He said, “A rod.”

2 Kings 4:1-7

1 Now a certain woman of the wives of the sons of the prophets cried out to Elisha, saying, “Your servant my husband is dead. You know that your servant feared Yahweh. Now the creditor has come to take for himself my two children to be slaves.”

2 Elisha said to her, “What should I do for you? Tell me: what do you have in the house?” She said, “Your servant has nothing in the house, except a pot of oil.”

3 Then he said, “Go, borrow empty containers from all your neighbors. Don’t borrow just a few containers.

4 Go in and shut the door on you and on your sons, and pour oil into all those containers; and set aside those which are full.”

5 So she went from him, and shut the door on herself and on her sons. They brought the containers to her, and she poured oil.

6 When the containers were full, she said to her son, “Bring me another container.” He said to her, “There isn’t another container.” Then the oil stopped flowing.

7 Then she came and told the man of God. He said, “Go, sell the oil, and pay your debt; and you and your sons live on the rest.”

John 6:5-13

5 Jesus therefore lifting up his eyes, and seeing that a great multitude was coming to him, said to Philip, “Where are we to buy bread, that these may eat?”

6 This he said to test him, for he himself knew what he would do.

7 Philip answered him, “Two hundred denarii worth of bread is not sufficient for them, that everyone of them may receive a little.”

8 One of his disciples, Andrew, Simon Peter’s brother, said to him,

9 “There is a boy here who has five barley loaves and two fish, but what are these among so many?”

10 Jesus said, “Have the people sit down.” Now there was much grass in that place. So the men sat down, in number about five thousand.

11 Jesus took the loaves; and having given thanks, he distributed to the disciples, and the disciples to those who were sitting down; likewise also of the fish as much as they desired.

12 When they were filled, he said to his disciples, “Gather up the broken pieces which are left over, that nothing be lost.”

13 So they gathered them up, and filled twelve baskets with broken pieces from the five barley loaves, which were left over by those who had eaten.

Enter the Text

Moses had a staff. The widow had oil. A boy had lunch. None of them began with what looked sufficient. Yet God did not begin by asking them for what was absent. He asked for surrender and faithful movement with what was already present.

The master's goods in Matthew 25 were not casual possessions. They were entrusted wealth. In the same way, your home, body, child, time, money, gift, idea, healing and hidden place of prayer are not small because they are ordinary. They are places of trust.

Stewardship begins with seeing rightly. What you overlook may be the very material God intends to use.

Builder's Window: The Widow and the Oil

The widow entered her crisis focused on what she lacked. Elisha asked, "What do you have in the house?" Her answer was almost dismissive: "Nothing... except a little oil."

The little oil was not the whole miracle; it was the material through which obedience moved. She gathered vessels, poured, and discovered that what was placed before God did not run out until there were no more vessels.

The Root Question

What have I called too ordinary, too small, too late, too broken or too insufficient for God to use?

Reflect

- What is presently in my care that I have minimised?
- Where have I postponed faithfulness while waiting for a different season?

Pray

Lord, open my eyes to see what You have already placed in my hands. Deliver me from overlooking today because I am preoccupied with tomorrow. Teach me to tend what You have entrusted to me with joy and reverence. Amen.

Respond

Make an honest inventory of the people, places, resources, gifts and responsibilities presently in your care.

WHAT IS IN MY HANDS RIGHT NOW

Steward Your Measure

“To each according to his own ability.” — Matthew 25:15 (WEB)

Today's Truth

Your measure is not the first issue. Your posture toward the One who entrusted you is.

Rooted Scripture Thread

Matthew 25:15 — The master entrusts differently, but intentionally.

Romans 12:3–8 — Grace and gifts are given in measure; sober judgement matters.

1 Corinthians 12:4–7 — There are different gifts and workings, but the same Spirit.

Exodus 18:17–23 — Moses is corrected for carrying alone what should be shared.

Luke 10:1 — Jesus sends disciples ahead in pairs, not as isolated labourers.

FULL SCRIPTURE READINGS

Read these passages slowly. Let the Word carry the weight of the teaching before you move into reflection.

Matthew 25:15

15 To one he gave five talents, to another two, to another one; to each according to his own ability. Then he went on his journey.

Romans 12:3-8

3 For I say, through the grace that was given me, to every man who is among you, not to think of himself more highly than he ought to think; but to think reasonably, as God has apportioned to each person a measure of faith.

4 For even as we have many members in one body, and all the members don't have the same function,

5 so we, who are many, are one body in Christ, and individually members one of another.

6 Having gifts differing according to the grace that was given to us, if prophecy, let us prophesy according to the proportion of our faith;

7 or service, let us give ourselves to service; or he who teaches, to his teaching;

8 or he who exhorts, to his exhorting: he who gives, let him do it with generosity; he who rules, with diligence; he who shows mercy, with cheerfulness.

1 Corinthians 12:4-7

4 Now there are various kinds of gifts, but the same Spirit.

5 There are various kinds of service, and the same Lord.

6 There are various kinds of workings, but the same God, who works all things in all.

7 But to each one is given the manifestation of the Spirit for the profit of all.

Exodus 18:17-23

17 Moses' father-in-law said to him, "The thing that you do is not good.

18 You will surely wear away, both you, and this people that is with you; for the thing is too heavy for you. You are not able to perform it yourself alone.

19 Listen now to my voice. I will give you counsel, and God be with you. You represent the people before God, and bring the causes to God.

20 You shall teach them the statutes and the laws, and shall show them the way in which they must walk, and the work that they must do.

21 Moreover you shall provide out of all the people able men which fear God: men of truth, hating unjust gain; and place such over them, to be rulers of thousands, rulers of hundreds, rulers of fifties, and rulers of tens.

22 Let them judge the people at all times. It shall be that every great matter they shall bring to you, but every small matter they shall judge themselves. So shall it be easier for you, and they shall share the load with you.

23 If you will do this thing, and God commands you so, then you will be able to endure, and all these people also will go to their place in peace."

Luke 10:1

1 Now after these things, the Lord also appointed seventy others, and sent them two by two ahead of him into every city and place, where he was about to come.

Enter the Text

The servants received different amounts, but neither worth nor belonging was determined by the amount. The master knew them. He did not entrust randomly, and He did not demand that the one-talent servant perform the work of the five-talent servant.

We are not told the five-talent servant's private thoughts, but his response reveals a heart willing to trust. He moved immediately. He received the master's goods as something worth working with, not a burden from which he needed to protect himself.

The one-talent servant begins his explanation with his view of the master: "I knew you... you are a hard man." Then comes the fruit of that belief: "I was afraid." His issue was not that he had less; he was afraid of the One who gave it. Fear made him preserve instead of participate.

Comparison turns someone else's assignment into a measuring stick for your own faithfulness. It can push you to overextend, resent your season or despise what you have received. Wise builders know that limits are not always lack; sometimes they are instruction.

Builder's Window: Moses Learns to Share the Load

Moses was leading people faithfully, yet Jethro told him, "What you are doing is not good." The work was too heavy because he was trying to carry it alone.

Some women call exhaustion stewardship because they fear that asking for help means failure. But Moses' correction teaches us that structure, delegation and limits can be forms of obedience.

Builder's Window: No One Is the Star of the Show

Jesus did not model a lone-ranger life. He appointed twelve disciples around Him, and later sent disciples out two by two. If Jesus did not approach the work of the Kingdom as a private performance, why do we believe we must carry every part of a vision alone?

A vision can be entrusted to you without every task being assigned to you. Stewardship includes release, delegation and humility. If cooking pap is always burning, Martha, the ministry of pap is not yours. Hand it to your sister or daughter. The need may be real, but it is not proof that you are the person appointed to meet it.

NO ONE IS THE STAR OF THE SHOW.

THE PART I NEED TO RELEASE, DELEGATE OR SHARE

The Root Question

When God places something in my hands, do I receive it as a holy trust to cultivate—or as a risky burden from which I must protect myself?

Prayer Declaration

I will not receive fear as wisdom. God is good, wise and faithful. What He places in my hands is not a trap; it is a trust. I will not bury my measure to avoid exposure or disappointment. By His Spirit, I will receive my assignment with humility, courage and faithful action.

Reflect

- Where am I comparing my measure to someone else's?
- What am I believing about God that makes me afraid to move with what He entrusted to me?
- What responsibility is mine now, and what belongs to God or to someone else?

Pray

Father, free me from comparison, fear and the pressure to prove myself. Correct every place where I have misread Your heart. Give me wisdom to recognise my measure and courage to steward it well. Make me faithful, not frantic. Amen.

Respond

Write two lists: "Mine to carry now" and "Not mine to carry now."

MY MEASURE IN THIS SEASON

Build Capacity Through Stewardship

“He who is faithful in a very little is faithful also in much.” — Luke 16:10 (WEB)

Today's Truth

Faithful stewardship builds capacity. The small responsibility is often where God trains the hands that will carry more.

Rooted Scripture Thread

Matthew 25:16–17 — The first two servants respond immediately and put the trust to work.

Luke 16:10–12 — Faithfulness in little and in another's things prepares us for more.

1 Timothy 4:14–15 — Do not neglect the gift; practise so that progress is visible.

Proverbs 24:27 — Prepare your work outside, then build your house.

FULL SCRIPTURE READINGS

Read these passages slowly. Let the Word carry the weight of the teaching before you move into reflection.

Matthew 25:16-17

16 Immediately he who received the five talents went and traded with them, and made another five talents.

17 In the same way, he also who got the two gained another two.

Luke 16:10-12

10 He who is faithful in a very little is faithful also in much. He who is dishonest in a very little is also dishonest in much.

11 If therefore you have not been faithful in the unrighteous mammon, how will you commit to your trust the true riches?

12 If you have not been faithful in that which is another's, how will you give you that which is your own?

1 Timothy 4:14-15

14 Don't neglect the gift that is in you, which was given to you by prophecy, with the laying on of the hands of the elders.

15 Be diligent in these things. Give yourself wholly to them, that your progress may be revealed to all.

Proverbs 24:27

27 Prepare your work outside, and get your fields ready. Afterwards, build your house.

Enter the Text

The word “immediately” matters. The faithful servants did not wait for a perfect plan, public validation, full understanding or a larger assignment. They began to work with what had been entrusted. Obey now; understand later. Clarity often meets us on the path of obedience.

Fear may speak, but it must not lead. To fear God is not to be terrified of Him; it is to honour Him as weightier than discomfort, uncertainty, embarrassment, loss or the opinions of people. When God is Master, you can step out before you understand every outcome.

Being afraid does not automatically mean fear has become an idol. But when we repeatedly let fear make our final decisions against God's instruction, fear has become the authority we serve. When you obey God while afraid, you declare that God is your Master. When you keep obeying fear above God, you make fear your master.

Capacity is not only a personality trait or a natural ability. It is formed through practice: managing the budget, returning the message, protecting rest, tending a room, developing a skill, keeping a promise, building a system, learning to say no.

We often pray for increased capacity while resisting the ordinary practices that create it. God may be building the hands that will carry more through the thing you want to outgrow.

Builder's Window: Timothy and the Gift

Paul does not tell Timothy merely to admire his gift or wait until he feels ready. He tells him not to neglect it, to practise it and to give himself to it. Progress was meant to become visible. Your gift needs more than inspiration. It needs faithful practice, safe accountability and room to mature.

Builder's Window: Rooted: The PDF Was the Seed

Rooted did not begin as a website, a polished platform or a full digital ecosystem. It began with PDFs. Those PDFs became a WhatsApp discipleship space; teaching then found its voice through audio; the community grew into structured courses; and those courses needed a home. Now Rooted builds websites that speak its identity.

Do not despise the PDF. You may be holding the first form of a future platform. If you only obey when the assignment looks impressive, you are not following God; you are protecting your image. You cannot pray for the website while despising the PDF. You cannot ask for the course while refusing to release the first thing God placed in your hands.

DO NOT DESPISE THE PDF.

MY FIRST FAITHFUL RELEASE

The Root Question

Where has fear become the authority I consult before I obey God? What is my “PDF” right now—the simple form of obedience I keep dismissing because it does not yet resemble the full vision?

Prayer Declaration

God is my Master, not fear. I will not wait for comfort before I obey. I will move with what God has placed in my hands, trusting that clarity often meets me on the path of obedience. I will not despise the simple beginning, because faithfulness is how capacity is built.

Reflect

- Which small practice would strengthen my ability to carry what I am praying for?
- What system, skill, boundary or rhythm do I need to build?
- Where have I waited for comfort instead of moving in obedience?

Pray

God, make me teachable in the small things. I will not wait for comfort before I obey. Help me to receive hidden training as preparation, not punishment, and to trust that You meet me as I move. Build in me the capacity to carry what You choose to entrust to me. Amen.

Respond

Choose one small daily practice for the next seven days. Make it specific, faithful and realistic.

MY CAPACITY-BUILDING PRACTICE

Do Not Bury What God Gave You

“Take away therefore the talent from him, and give it to him who has the ten talents.” — Matthew 25:28 (WEB)

Today's Truth

Fear calls it protection. Comparison calls it insignificance. Delay calls it waiting on God. But burying what God gave you is still burying it.

Rooted Scripture Thread

Matthew 25:18, 24–30 — The third servant buries the talent because fear has shaped his view of the master.

Judges 6:11–16 — Gideon is found hiding, yet God calls him into courageous obedience.

1 Samuel 15:22–23 — Saul's selective obedience is called rebellion and stubbornness.

2 Timothy 1:6–7 — Fan into flame the gift of God; fear is not the Spirit God gives.

Proverbs 18:9 — Slackness and destruction are connected.

FULL SCRIPTURE READINGS

Read these passages slowly. Let the Word carry the weight of the teaching before you move into reflection.

Matthew 25:18

18 But he who received the one talent went away and dug in the earth, and hid his lord's money.

Matthew 25:24-30

24 "He also who had received the one talent came and said, 'Lord, I knew you that you are a hard man, reaping where you did not sow, and gathering where you did not scatter.

25 I was afraid, and went away and hid your talent in the earth. Behold, you have what is yours.'

26 "But his lord answered him, 'You wicked and slothful servant. You knew that I reap where I didn't sow, and gather where I didn't scatter.

27 You ought therefore to have deposited my money with the bankers, and at my coming I should have received back my own with interest.

28 Take away therefore the talent from him, and give it to him who has the ten talents.

29 For to everyone who has will be given, and he will have abundance, but from him who doesn't have, even that which he has will be taken away.

30 Throw out the unprofitable servant into the outer darkness, where there will be weeping and gnashing of teeth.'

Judges 6:11-16

11 Yahweh's angel came, and sat under the oak which was in Ophrah, that belonged to Joash the Abiezrite. His son Gideon was beating out wheat in the wine press, to hide it from the Midianites.

12 Yahweh's angel appeared to him, and said to him, "Yahweh is with you, you mighty man of valor!"

13 Gideon said to him, "Oh, my lord, if Yahweh is with us, why then has all this happened to us? Where are all his wondrous works which our fathers told us of, saying, 'Didn't Yahweh bring us up from Egypt?' But now Yahweh has cast us off, and delivered us into the hand of Midian."

14 Yahweh looked at him, and said, "Go in this your might, and save Israel from the hand of Midian. Haven't I sent you?"

15 He said to him, "O Lord, how shall I save Israel? Behold, my family is the poorest in Manasseh, and I am the least in my father's house."

16 Yahweh said to him, "Surely I will be with you, and you shall strike the Midianites as one man."

1 Samuel 15:22-23

22 Samuel said, "Has Yahweh as great delight in burnt offerings and sacrifices, as in obeying Yahweh's voice? Behold, to obey is better than sacrifice, and to listen than the fat of rams.

23 For rebellion is as the sin of witchcraft, and stubbornness is as idolatry and teraphim. Because you have rejected Yahweh's word, he has also rejected you from being king."

2 Timothy 1:6-7

6 For this cause, I remind you that you should stir up the gift of God which is in you through the laying on of my hands.

7 For God didn't give us a spirit of fear, but of power, love, and self-control.

Proverbs 18:9

9 One who is slack in his work is brother to him who is a master of destruction.

Enter the Text

The third servant says, “I knew you,” but what follows is a distorted picture of the master: harsh, unsafe and impossible to please. His buried talent is not only a management failure. It is the fruit of fear and a false belief about the one who entrusted him.

He is not judged for receiving less. Nor is he asked to duplicate the five-talent servant. He is accountable because he refused to participate with what he had. An untouched assignment is not automatically a faithful assignment.

Delayed obedience is still disobedience. Partial obedience is still disobedience. When God has spoken plainly and we keep delaying, negotiating or selecting the parts we prefer, we place our own reasoning above His instruction.

The warning about the talent being given to another is sober. What we continually refuse to steward may be entrusted elsewhere. This is not a message that people are disposable to God; it is a call to refuse paralysis while grace is inviting us to begin again.

Builder’s Window: Gideon at the Winepress

Gideon is threshing wheat in a winepress, hiding from the Midianites. God meets him in hiding and calls him “mighty man of valour.” He does not shame Gideon for fear; He confronts it with His presence and sends him forward. God can meet you in the place you hid, but He loves you enough not to leave the thing buried.

Builder’s Window: Saul and Selective Obedience

Saul did not refuse God in a dramatic speech. He kept what God told him to destroy, then tried to explain the disobedience as worship. He called it sacrifice, but Samuel exposed it as rebellion.

First Samuel 15:23 says rebellion is as the sin of sorcery, and stubbornness as idolatry. The issue is not simply that Saul made a mistake; he set his own judgement above God’s word. We must not spiritualise delay, baptise compromise or offer God a version of obedience He did not ask for.

DELAYED OBEDIENCE IS STILL DISOBEDIENCE.

MY IMMEDIATE ACT OF OBEDIENCE

The Root Question

What have I buried because fear taught me to misread the heart of God? Where have I called delayed or selective obedience “wisdom” when God has already spoken?

Prayer Declaration

I will not negotiate with the instruction of God. I reject delayed and selective obedience. God’s Word is weightier than my fear, reasoning and comfort. I will respond to His voice with humility and immediate obedience.

Reflect

- What have I buried through fear, shame, disappointment or delay?
- Where have I called self-protection wisdom when it was actually avoidance?
- What instruction have I heard clearly but kept postponing?

Pray

Merciful God, forgive me for the ways I have hidden what You entrusted to me. I bring my fear and disappointment into Your light. Correct every false belief I hold about Your heart, and give me grace to begin again. Amen.

Respond

Name what you have buried. Then write the next faithful action, not the entire plan.

WHAT I AM UNCOVERING

Faithful With More

“Well done, good and faithful servant.” — Matthew 25:21 (WEB)

Today's Truth

More is not the goal. Faithfulness is. Yet a faithful woman becomes ready for whatever God chooses to entrust next.

Rooted Scripture Thread

Matthew 25:19–23 — After a long time the master returns, settles accounts and invites faithful servants into his joy.

Genesis 39:2–6; 41:38–41 — Joseph is trustworthy in a household before he is entrusted with a nation.

Deuteronomy 17:16–17 — Israel's king is warned against multiplying horses, wives, silver and gold.

1 Kings 10–11 — Solomon gains great wealth, horses and wives; his heart is later turned toward other gods.

Luke 16:10–12 — Faithfulness with little and with another's things prepares us for true riches.

FULL SCRIPTURE READINGS

Read these passages slowly. Let the Word carry the weight of the teaching before you move into reflection.

Matthew 25:19-23

19 “Now after a long time the lord of those servants came, and reconciled accounts with them.

20 He who received the five talents came and brought another five talents, saying, ‘Lord, you delivered to me five talents. Behold, I have gained another five talents besides them.’

21 “His lord said to him, ‘Well done, good and faithful servant. You have been faithful over a few things, I will set you over many things. Enter into the joy of your lord.’

22 “He also who got the two talents came and said, ‘Lord, you delivered to me two talents. Behold, I have gained another two talents besides them.’

23 “His lord said to him, ‘Well done, good and faithful servant. You have been faithful over a few things, I will set you over many things. Enter into the joy of your lord.’

Genesis 39:2-6

2 Yahweh was with Joseph, and he was a prosperous man. He was in the house of his master the Egyptian.

3 His master saw that Yahweh was with him, and that Yahweh made all that he did prosper in his hand.

4 Joseph found favor in his sight. He ministered to him, and he made him overseer over his house, and all that he had he put into his hand.

5 From the time that he made him overseer in his house, and over all that he had, Yahweh blessed the Egyptian’s house for Joseph’s sake. Yahweh’s blessing was on all that he had, in the house and in the field.

6 He left all that he had in Joseph’s hand. He didn’t concern himself with anything, except for the food which he ate. Joseph was well-built and handsome.

Genesis 41:38-41

38 Pharaoh said to his servants, “Can we find such a one as this, a man in whom is the Spirit of God?”

39 Pharaoh said to Joseph, “Because God has shown you all of this, there is no one so discreet and wise as you.

40 You shall be over my house, and according to your word will all my people be ruled. Only in the throne I will be greater than you.”

41 Pharaoh said to Joseph, “Behold, I have set you over all the land of Egypt.”

Deuteronomy 17:16-17

16 Only he shall not multiply horses to himself, nor cause the people to return to Egypt, to the end that he may multiply horses; because Yahweh has said to you, “You shall not go back that way again.”

17 He shall not multiply wives to himself, that his heart not turn away. He shall not greatly multiply to himself silver and gold.

1 Kings 10:26-29

26 Solomon gathered together chariots and horsemen. He had one thousand four hundred chariots, and twelve thousand horsemen, that he kept in the chariot cities and with the king at Jerusalem.

27 The king made silver as common as stones in Jerusalem, and cedars as common as the sycamore trees that are in the lowland.

28 The horses which Solomon had were brought out of Egypt. The king’s merchants received them in droves, each drove at a price.

29 A chariot came up and went out of Egypt for six hundred shekels of silver, and a horse for one hundred fifty shekels; and so they exported them to all the kings of the Hittites, and to the kings of Syria.

1 Kings 11:1-10

- 1 Now king Solomon loved many foreign women, together with the daughter of Pharaoh, women of the Moabites, Ammonites, Edomites, Sidonians, and Hittites;
- 2 of the nations concerning which Yahweh said to the children of Israel, “You shall not go among them, neither shall they come among you; for surely they will turn away your heart after their gods.” Solomon joined to these in love.
- 3 He had seven hundred wives, princesses, and three hundred concubines; and his wives turned away his heart.
- 4 When Solomon was old, his wives turned away his heart after other gods; and his heart was not perfect with Yahweh his God, as the heart of David his father was.
- 5 For Solomon went after Ashtoreth the goddess of the Sidonians, and after Milcom the abomination of the Ammonites.
- 6 Solomon did that which was evil in Yahweh’s sight, and didn’t go fully after Yahweh, as David his father did.
- 7 Then Solomon built a high place for Chemosh the abomination of Moab, on the mountain that is before Jerusalem, and for Molech the abomination of the children of Ammon.
- 8 So he did for all his foreign wives, who burned incense and sacrificed to their gods.
- 9 Yahweh was angry with Solomon, because his heart was turned away from Yahweh, the God of Israel, who had appeared to him twice,
- 10 and had commanded him concerning this thing, that he should not go after other gods; but he didn’t keep that which Yahweh commanded.

Luke 16:10-12

- 10 He who is faithful in a very little is faithful also in much. He who is dishonest in a very little is also dishonest in much.
- 11 If therefore you have not been faithful in the unrighteous mammon, how will you commit to your trust the true riches?
- 12 If you have not been faithful in that which is another’s, how will you give you that which is your own?

Enter the Text

The master returns after a long time. The parable teaches us how to live between entrustment and account: awake, active and faithful. The end is not a bigger platform; it is hearing “well done” and entering the joy of the master.

Sometimes more looks like influence, provision, a wider assignment or a new door. Sometimes it looks like peace, order, wisdom, healing or a home being rebuilt. Do not define increase too narrowly.

Starting with God is not the same as finishing with God. Mid-growth and enlargement can become the very place where we stop needing the God who gave the increase. We must not build a life so successful that it no longer requires obedience.

Matthew 25 does not end with talents. It continues with the least of these. Faithful stewardship becomes visible in how we treat people, not simply in what we achieve.

Builder’s Window: Joseph in Potiphar’s House

Joseph’s dream did not make him careless in the place he did not choose. In Potiphar’s house and then in prison, Scripture repeatedly says that what was under Joseph’s care prospered.

Faithfulness did not instantly remove Joseph from hardship, but it formed a trustworthy man. When the time came, he had both wisdom and character to carry national responsibility.

Builder’s Window: Solomon and the Danger of Enlargement

Solomon began with love for God, wisdom and a desire to build God’s house. Yet long before Solomon reigned, Moses warned that a king must not multiply horses, wives, silver or gold for himself. These were not arbitrary restrictions; they protected the king’s heart from self-reliance, compromise and misplaced worship.

Solomon eventually multiplied all three. He acquired horses and chariots, amassed wealth, and took many wives. First Kings 11 says his wives turned his heart after other gods. His tragedy is not that he had increase; it is that he allowed increase to become a place where God’s instruction no longer governed him.

Do not build a life so successful that it no longer requires obedience. Do not allow the thing God gave you to become the thing that replaces Him.

***I WILL NOT MERELY START WITH GOD. I WILL
FINISH WITH GOD.***

MY FINISHING-WELL PRINCIPLES

The Root Question

If God enlarges my life, will the version of me that receives more still belong to Him? What principles from the small season must remain non-negotiable?

Prayer Declaration

I will not merely start with God; I will finish with God. I will not leave behind the principles that carried me through the small season when God enlarges my territory. Provision will not become my identity. Increase will not replace intimacy. God remains my first love and my Master.

Reflect

- What kind of woman am I becoming through this season?
- How can my stewardship become visible love toward the people God has placed around me?
- What devotion, boundary, truth-teller or practice must not disappear when life becomes bigger?

Pray

Lord, I release my need to control the size and timing of my assignment. Make me a good and faithful steward. Help me to build well with what You have entrusted to me, and prepare me for whatever You place in my hands next. Keep my heart close to You in every season. Amen.

Respond

Write your personal stewardship commitment and sign it as a prayer before God.

MY STEWARDSHIP COMMITMENT

MY STEWARDSHIP INVENTORY

Return to this page monthly. Good builders do not only receive an assignment; they revisit the plans, count the material and build with intention.

MY HOME AND ENVIRONMENT — ONE FAITHFUL NEXT STEP

MY BODY, HEALTH AND REST — ONE FAITHFUL NEXT STEP

MY MONEY AND RESOURCES — ONE FAITHFUL NEXT STEP

MY RELATIONSHIPS — ONE FAITHFUL NEXT STEP

MY TIME AND ATTENTION — ONE FAITHFUL NEXT STEP

MY GIFTS, WORK AND CALLING — ONE FAITHFUL NEXT STEP

MY WALK WITH GOD — ONE FAITHFUL NEXT STEP

My Declaration

I will not bury what God has placed in my hands. I will faithfully steward the life He has given me. I will honour my present measure, build capacity through obedience, and become ready for whatever He chooses to entrust to me next.

SIGNED AND DATED

OPEN HANDS, A RESTED HEART



*“It is vain for you to rise up early, to stay up late, eating the bread of toil; for he gives sleep to his loved ones.”
— Psalm 127:2 (WEB)*

Stewardship Is Not Hoarding

God does not enlarge your hands so that you can close them around what He gives. He enlarges your hands so that you can carry responsibility, serve people, build faithfully and release what is needed. The faithful life is not a private performance or an accumulation project.

Matthew 25 moves from entrusted talents to the least of these. What we build must become visible love: food for the hungry, welcome for the stranger, care for the overlooked and faithfulness toward the people already near us.

Rest Is Stewardship

Rest and Sabbath are not rewards for finally doing enough. They are declarations that God remains Master when you stop working. A good builder knows when to build, when to release and when to rest. Refusing rest can quietly say, “Everything depends on me.” Faith receives the gift of sleep.

I WILL BUILD, RELEASE AND REST.

MY OPEN-HANDED YES AND MY SABBATH BOUNDARY

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